MODULE 1: INTRODUCTION TO TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

(CO: 2)

Complete Study Textbook, Professional Writing Guide & VIT FAT Question Bank

Aligned with Official VIT BAENG101 Course Page Syllabus, Question Bank, and Past FAT Papers

Scope of This Textbook (Official VIT Syllabus - All 6 Topics): (1) The Nature of Technical Writing, (2) Taxonomy of Technical Writing: Scientific Writing vs Technical Reporting, (3) Key distinctions & style conventions, (4) 5Cs of Technical Writing, (5) Business Communication principles, and (6) Professional business correspondence.

1 VIT FAT Exam Blueprint & Master Guidelines

Module 1 carries **15 to 20 marks** in BAENG101 FAT:

1. **Question Type A (10 Marks):** Comparison between General English / Creative Writing vs. Technical Writing, or Scientific Writing (journal paper) vs. Technical Reporting (feasibility / audit report).
2. **Question Type B (10 Marks):** The 5 Cs of Technical Writing (Clarity, Conciseness, Completeness, Concreteness, Correctness) applied to rewrite a flawed business memo or technical brief.

The 5 Cs	Core Principle	VIT Exam Rule & Transformation
Clarity	Unambiguous syntax, clear pronoun referents, straightforward subject-verb order.	Eliminate dangling modifiers; replace obscure jargon with precise technical terms.
Conciseness	Express maximum informational density in the minimum number of words.	Prune wordy phrases: replace 'in the event of' with 'if', 'at this point in time' with 'now'.
Completeness	Includes all essential technical parameters (who, what, where, when, why, how).	Ensure units, testing boundaries, and safety tolerances are never omitted.
Concreteness	Definite, specific, visual data rather than vague generalizations.	Replace 'the server crashed frequently' with 'the server crashed 4 times in 24 hours'.
Correctness	Accurate technical data, grammar, punctuation, and appropriate professional tone.	Verify standard SI units, correct concord, and zero typographical misprints.

2 Nature of Technical Writing & Taxonomy

2.1 Technical Writing vs. Creative / General Writing

- **Purpose:** Creative writing aims to entertain, evoke emotion, or express subjective artistic experience; Technical writing is transactional, utilitarian, and designed to inform, instruct, or persuade decision-makers to take action.
- **Audience:** General public vs. targeted professional stakeholders (engineers, managers, clients).
- **Tone & Style:** Subjective, poetic, figurative vs. objective, formal, impersonal, and fact-driven.
- **Format:** Narrative paragraphs vs. structured documents utilizing headings, bulleted lists, tables, charts, callouts, and schematics.

2.2 Scientific Writing vs. Technical Reporting

- **Scientific Writing (Research Articles):** Focused on primary inquiry, testing scientific hypotheses, expanding fundamental human knowledge, and peer-reviewed journal publication (IMRAD structure: Introduction, Methods, Results, and Discussion).
- **Technical Reporting (Industry Reports):** Practical problem-solving documents (Feasibility studies, Inspection reports, Incident post-mortems, System architecture specifications) aimed at organizational stakeholders for immediate business execution.